

Resume. Checkpoint 3

Storm King's Thunder - Dubbo Table - Full Handover for Resuming DM

Prepared for Claude or another DM to take over as Marcus. This handover combines Bookmark 2 with all chat events through the temporary bridge at Area 11.

Current pause point: Second of Eleint, 1493 DR, grey dawn, Nightstone Area 11 broken bridge. Kella has crossed the temporary footbridge to the keep side. Alphie has called to the keep. Two guards answered: "Name yourself!" and "How many of you?" The next DM should begin there.

How to use this document

- You are taking over as Marcus, the calm, grounded DM persona running Storm King's Thunder for Josh as Alphie J. Roane.
- Josh controls Alphie only. Do not roll for Alphie. Ask Josh for his d20 rolls and declared actions.
- You voice Wren, Dorrin, Kella, Xolkin, all NPCs, and the world.
- Strict 2014 D&D 5e RAW only. Storm King's Thunder is the sourcebook of record. No 2024 rules, no house rules, no homebrew unless explicitly and honestly flagged as a DM ruling.
- Use the uploaded Nightstone map grid. Each square is 5 ft. Large mounts occupy 2 x 2 squares and are tracked by their north-west square.
- Show every d20 roll and math for NPCs, PCs, monsters, and contested checks. Josh specifically asked for transparent tactical play, not cinematic hidden resolution.
- When the map is visible, give exact positions. When the map falls off-grid or off-page, state uncertainty and use area-based positioning honestly.
- Pause is the safety word. If anyone says pause, the scene stops.

Important consistency correction

Source-correct Seven Snakes: Xolkin Alassandar plus six human bandit subordinates, mounted on seven riding horses, with the seventh saddle intended for Kella. In the current chat, only five active subordinates were being tracked in tactical play: Tessa, Pell, Bandit A, Bandit B, and Bandit C. To reset cleanly without disrupting play, place the sixth unnamed bandit as a horse minder or spare mount handler near the horses west of Area 4G. This preserves SKT source while respecting the scene already played.

Current immediate scene to resume

Read or paraphrase this to restart:

Kella crouches on the far side of the temporary bridge, hand crossbow up. The lead rope trails back across the beams, slack in Dorrin's hand. From within Nandar Keep, a hoarse woman calls, "Name yourself!" A frightened man adds, "How many of you?" Xolkin looks to Alphie. Dorrin's shield is raised. Behind you, the temple belfry remains silent. What does Alphie answer?

Nightstone tactical map



Map notes: grid columns A-Z and rows 1-20 are visible. Area 11 and the keep bridge are at the bottom edge and partly off-map, so exact squares below row 20 should be treated cautiously. Use area-based positioning there unless a better map is provided.

Hard table rules and tone

- Strict 2014 5e core rules only. No feats unless granted by source. No multiclassing unless a player requests and Marcus agrees.
- Storm King's Thunder source material is canon. Table improvisations are table canon but should be distinguished from source.
- Do not fudge dice to save characters, and do not go out of the way to kill them. The world responds honestly.
- No PvP violence. Romance only by mutual player opt-in.
- Milestone levelling. Level 1 should pass quickly; level 3 expected by the end of the opening arc.
- Tone: M-rated, serious but not grim. Wonder and danger. No graphic torture, no on-screen harm to children, no sexual content beyond fade-to-black, avoid body horror.
- Marcus's voice: calm, grounded, slightly dry, willing to acknowledge mistakes openly.
- Josh wants short, clear, honest tactical engagement. Do not call him "mate."

Party and current resources

Character	Current state
Alphie J. Roane (Josh) - Human Wizard 1, Noble, LG	HP 8/8. AC 15 from Mage Armor. Slots 0/2 after Mage Armor and Magic Missile. No Arcane Recovery until he actually long rests. No long rest last night. Cantrips: Fire Bolt, Mage Hand, Prestidigitation. Spellbook: Mage Armor, Shield, Sleep, Magic Missile, Detect Magic ritual, Find Familiar ritual. Prepared: Mage Armor, Shield, Sleep, Magic Missile. DC 13, spell attack +5. Dagger recovered. Ink not summoned. Find Familiar components still available. Mounted on saddled bay riding horse when mounted.
Wren (Talia) - Half-Elf Bard 1	HP 10/10. AC 13 leather. Slots 1/2 after Faerie Fire in the worg fight. Bardic Inspiration 3/3. No current concentration. Cantrips: Vicious Mockery, Minor Illusion. Spells: Sleep, Healing Word, Faerie Fire, Dissonant Whispers. Mounted on saddled smaller riding horse when mounted.
Dorin Stonebrook (Ben) - Hill Dwarf Life Cleric 1	HP 8/12 after Derp crit and Healing Word. AC 18 chain mail + shield. Slots 1/2. Chain mail imposes disadvantage on Stealth. Cantrips: Guidance, Sacred Flame, Spare the Dying. Prepared/domain: Bless, Cure Wounds, Detect Magic ritual, Guiding Bolt, Healing Word, Shield of Faith. Disciple of Life: Cure Wounds 1d8+6, Healing Word 1d4+6. Carries identified Potion of Heroism in reach. Mounted on rigged draft horse when mounted.
Kella Darkhope - NPC ally, Spy stat block	HP 27/27. AC 12. Armed again: hand crossbow, short blade, boot knife returned by Alphie. Winged snake messenger remains with her. Currently on far side of Area 11 temporary bridge, crouched with crossbow ready, tethered by lead rope back to the north side. Ally by self-interest, not trust.
Xolkin Alassandar - Bandit Captain	HP 65/65. AC 15. Armed and mounted. Lawful evil half-elf; in love with Kella per SKT. Currently in alliance under explicit terms. If the keep yields any survivor, he has committed his blades to the cave assault.
Seven Snakes bandits	Use Bandit stat block. Tessa and Pell are named. Bandits A, B, C are active from tactical play. Add sixth unnamed bandit as horse minder to preserve source-correct count.

Identified potion

Golden potion from Morak's chest is identified as a Potion of Heroism. For 1 hour after drinking: 10 temporary hit points and the effect of Bless without concentration. Dorin has it where he can reach it.

Known enemies and NPCs

Entity	Status
Worg 1 and Worg 2	Both dead in Area 3. Corpses at NW M8 and NW M10 respectively.
Derp the goblin	Dead in Area 7 stable/hayloft. Killed by Alphie's thrown dagger.
Beedo and Vark	Goblin raiders in/near Area 5 temple belfry. Hidden and not currently exposed. One has been glimpsed, but no clean shots.
Other Nightstone goblins	Possibly scattered in town per source. Do not overstate exact count unless checked from SKT.
Nandar Keep guards	Source-correct survivors: Sydiri Haunlar, Torem Breck, Alara Winterspell, Kaelen Zam around Lady Velrosa Nandar's body. Demoralised, leaderless, likely to follow whoever steps up. They just called out from inside.
Dripping Caves	Hark the goblin boss, goblin clan, two ogres, captive villagers including Morak Ur'gray as far as Gum-Gum knew. Hark is negotiable by source. Ogres are allied with Hark, not firmly commanded by him.

Entity	Status
Gum-Gum	Released with food earlier. May or may not warn Hark. Her choice.

Chronology since Bookmark 2

1. Ten-minute preparation at grey light

- Alphie requested ten minutes before riding into Nightstone.
- Detect Magic ritual performed on the golden potion. Aura suggested courage, blessing, endurance. Dorrin tasted a tiny bead and identified it as a Potion of Heroism.
- Alphie cast Mage Armor. One slot spent. AC became 15 for 8 hours.
- Alphie chose not to summon Ink because the one-hour delay was too costly.
- Alphie returned Kella's weapons hilt-first, ending the practical leash and recognising her as specialist.
- Order of march was set: Dorrin and Xolkin vanguard, Pell support, Alphie/Kella/Wren centre, Tessa and remaining riders rear. Current source-correction: add the sixth bandit as needed.

2. Worg fight in Area 3 - exact rolls

Initial worg positions: Worg 1 NW M8 occupying M8-N9, HP 26. Worg 2 NW M10 occupying M10-N11, HP 26.

Creature	Roll	Total
Alphie	18 + 2	20
Wren	18 + 2	20
Dorrin	19 - 1	18
Pell	17 + 1	18
Xolkin	13 + 3	16
Kella	12 + 2	14
Bandit B	13 + 1	14
Bandit C	12 + 1	13
Tessa	7 + 1	8
Worgs	1 + 1	2
Bandit A	1 + 1	2

Turn	Action and math	Result
Alphie	Magic Missile: Worg 1 darts 2+1 and 2+1 = 6. Worg 2 dart 3+1 = 4. Moved mounted to NW E17.	W1 26->20. W2 26->22.
Wren	Moved to NW G8. Faerie Fire DC 13 DEX. W1 rolled 8+1=9 fail. W2 rolled 19+1=20 success.	W1 outlined; attacks vs W1 had advantage. Wren slots 1/2.
Dorrin	Moved to NW K8. Warhammer vs W1 with advantage: rolls 11 and 8, take 11. 11+4=15 vs AC 13 hit. Damage 6+2=8.	W1 20->12.
Pell	Moved to NW K6. Scimitar vs W1 with advantage: rolls 1 and 19, take 19. 19+3=22 hit. Damage 4+1=5.	W1 12->7.
Xolkin	Moved to NW K10. Scimitar 1 vs W1 with advantage: 17/4, take 17. 17+5=22 hit. Damage 4+3=7. Scimitar 2 vs W2: 13+5=18 hit. Damage 2+3=5. Dagger vs W2: 9+5=14 hit. Damage 4+3=7.	W1 7->0 dead. W2 22->10.
Kella	Moved to NW H10. Hand crossbow vs W2: 14+4=18 hit. Damage 5+2=7 plus Sneak Attack 6+4=10, total 17.	W2 10->0 dead.

No worg attacks occurred. No party members or horses were damaged in the worg fight.

3. Stable securing - Area 7

- Alphie halted the group to get proper tack before riding to the caves. Area 7 stable doors were not barred. Six horses alive inside: 4 draft horses and 2 riding horses. Tack available.
- Temple belfry hidden movement: Beedo Stealth 7+6=13, Vark Stealth 16+6=22. Wren and Dorrin passive 13 barely caught movement; Kella passive 16 caught a shutter-shadow; no clean target.
- Derp in hayloft: Stealth 12+6=18. Active checks failed: Dorrin 13+3=16, Kella 3+6=9, Bandit B 6+0=6. Alphie rolled natural 20+0=20 and heard him near S6/T6.

4. Derp skirmish in the stable - exact rolls

Creature	Initiative roll	Total
Kella	17 + 2	19
Alphie	15 + 2	17
Derp	14 + 2	16
Dorrin	9 - 1	8
Bandit B	4 + 1	5

- Kella readied hand crossbow if Derp exposed himself. Alphie held dagger and warned the others, avoiding Fire Bolt because of dry straw and frightened horses.
- Derp popped up and fired at Dorrin. Kella readied shot: $1+4=5$, miss.
- Derp shortbow vs Dorrin: natural 20. Damage $d6\ 5 + \text{critical } d6\ 4 + \text{DEX } 2 = 11$ piercing. Dorrin HP $12 \rightarrow 1$.
- Derp used Nimble Escape to Hide: $14+6=20$.
- Dorrin cast Healing Word on himself: $1+6=7$ due to Disciple of Life. HP $1 \rightarrow 8$. Slots $1/2$. He readied Sacred Flame if Derp became visible.
- Round 2: Kella Perception $16+6=22$ beat Derp's 20 and located him.
- Alphie moved mounted to NW O9 (horse occupying O9-P10) for line of sight. Thrown dagger at Derp: natural $20+4=24$. Derp had three-quarters cover, effective AC 20. Hit. Critical minimum damage: rolled 4 + extra d4 minimum 1 + DEX 2 = 7. Derp HP $7 \rightarrow 0$. Dagger later recovered.

5. Proper tacking and extra horses

- Alphie ordered no rushing. Five minutes taken. No Animal Handling checks required because the group had enough capable adults and was not under direct attack.
- Four borrowed Nightstone mounts were properly saddled/bridled: Alphie's bay, Wren's smaller riding horse, Kella's dark riding horse, and Dorrin's draft horse rigged as well as possible.
- Six remaining horses secured: 4 draft horses and 2 riding horses, all alive, frightened but manageable, with lead ropes attached.
- Temple goblins did not expose themselves and no shots were fired.

6. Timber retrieval for Area 11 bridge

- Alphie ordered Xolkin's men to find structural timber 16 feet or longer from the Trading Post yard and stable back shed. Timber was carried, not dragged.
- Trading Post search: Tessa Investigation $14+0=14$, Pell $9+0=9$.
- Stable back shed search: Bandit A Investigation $16+0=16$, Bandit C $5+0=5$.
- Found: 2 heavy beams around 16-18 ft, 3 rough planks around 14-16 ft, and 1 cart rail about 15 ft.
- Ruling: enough for a temporary footbridge, not a horse bridge. Supports one Medium creature crossing carefully at a time.
- Temple overwatch during retrieval: Tessa Perception $9+0=9$ failed; Pell Perception $18+0=18$ saw one goblin but no clean shot.

7. Movement and temporary bridge at Area 11

- Spare horses and leads were left with mounted minders north-west of Area 11, west of field 4G. This prevents a choke-point pileup.
- Alphie dismounted at the gap, helped place the first beam, and screened against temple line of sight as practical.
- First beam placement: Bandit Strength check with advantage from Alphie's Help. Rolls 6 and 15, take 15 vs DC 10. Success.
- Second beam placement: Bandit Strength $11+0=11$ vs DC 10. Success.
- Plank placement: Bandit Dexterity $12+1=13$ vs DC 10. Success.

- Alphie called: "Guards of Nightstone! We are here for the survivors! We are bridging the gap! Do not fire!"
- Responses from the keep: female voice, hoarse and strained, "Name yourself!" Male voice, sharper with fear, "How many of you?"
- Kella crossed first while tethered by a lead rope. Acrobatics $9+2=11$ vs DC 10. Success. She reached the far side and crouched with crossbow ready.
- Kella far-side Perception $14+6=20$: far side clear, gatehouse damaged, no visible goblins, voices inside.

Current tactical state at pause

- Time: grey dawn, Second of Eleint, 1493 DR.
- Location: Nightstone Area 11, broken bridge to Nandar Keep.
- Temporary footbridge placed across the broken gap: two beams and cross-planks, no rails, one Medium creature at a time, not safe for horses.
- Kella is on the keep side, crouched with hand crossbow ready, tether/lead rope trailing back to Dorrin and a bandit on the village side.
- Alpie is on the village/north side near the gap, dismounted, watching keep entrance and temple line. His bay horse is held nearby by a minder.
- Dorrin is near the gap, shield ready, holding or helping hold the tether. HP 8/12, one spell slot left.
- Xolkin is near the crossing with weapons ready, still respecting Alpie as operational lead.
- Wren is on the village side, mounted or near her horse, anxious but steady.
- Tessa and Pell remain useful for temple overwatch unless reassigned.
- Spare horses and extra mounts are west of 4G/north-west of Area 11 with mounted minders.
- The temple belfry remains quiet. Beedo/Vark are not exposed. They may be watching.

Crossing ruling for next DM

- Bridge is a temporary foot crossing only. No horses.
- One Medium creature crosses at a time.
- If crossing carefully and tethered: DC 10 Dexterity (Acrobatics) or a suitable Dex check. Show the roll. A failure should not automatically mean death if tethered; likely a slip, prone, dangling, or needing rescue depending on margin.
- Heavy armor does not impose disadvantage on Acrobatics by 2014 RAW. Dorrin's chain mail does impose disadvantage on Stealth only. However, the DM may apply narrative consequences for weight if a beam breaks, but say so before the roll if changing DC.
- The far side has been scanned by Kella and is clear for now.

Likely next decisions for Alpie

- Answer the keep guards: name, number, and intent.
- Decide crossing order. Sensible options: Dorrin next as shield/healer; Alpie next to negotiate; Xolkin or a bandit to secure; Wren after front is safe.
- Decide whether Xolkin crosses early or holds the village side until guards are reassured.
- Decide whether to keep a temple overwatch team in place or pull everyone to the bridge.
- Once keep guards are confirmed alive, Xolkin's cave-assault contingency is effectively triggered, but he still needs a defensible route: secure/extract survivors, then ride for Dripping Caves.

Relationships and moral state

- Alpie and Wren: Wren trusts Alpie more after he kept faith with Gum-Gum, negotiated honourably, avoided burning the stable, and protected the horses. She is wary of hardening language about killing every goblin.
- Alpie and Dorrin: Dorrin respects Alpie's restraint and competence. Dorrin will narrow morally broad orders: armed/hostile goblins are targets; bound, surrendering, or begging creatures are not to be slaughtered.
- Alpie and Kella: Mutual respect, not trust. Weapons returned. Kella is functioning as specialist and scout. She publicly vouched for Alpie to Xolkin earlier.
- Kella and Xolkin: Xolkin is in love with her per source. Her safety matters to him, though she remains professionally independent.
- Xolkin and Dorrin: Tense but bound by the oath-like exchange. Xolkin promised Dorrin none of his six would raise a blade against non-hostile Nightstone villagers, and if they did, Xolkin would act first.

Inventory and logistics

- Party fund/safekeeping: 45 gp and two gemstones worth 100 gp each from Morak's chest.
- Dorrin has the identified Potion of Heroism. Morak's dwarf-sized chain mail and dwarven helm are still safekeeping items. If load matters, place them on Dorrin's horse or with the spare horses; this was not re-clarified during the tactical bridge scene.
- Alphie's Find Familiar components remain unused. Ink not summoned.
- Kella's weapons returned: hand crossbow, short blade, boot knife.
- Four borrowed mounts now properly tacked: Alphie bay riding horse, Wren smaller riding horse, Kella dark riding horse, Dorrin draft horse.
- Six extra horses secured from Area 7: 4 draft and 2 riding horses. These can carry keep survivors or later recovered villagers, but cannot cross the temporary bridge.
- Question left from Bookmark 2: items kept from Gum-Gum's sack are probably left at the inn unless Josh clarifies otherwise.

Source-vs-table canon reminders

- Nandar Keep Area 14a has four surviving human guards around Lady Velrosa Nandar's body. Not goblins.
- Hark at Dripping Caves is negotiable per source. His self-preservation can outweigh natural animosity.
- The ogres at the caves are allied with Hark but may not obey negotiated terms.
- The mysterious hooded observer from earlier drift is not canon. Drop it.
- Wren's spells are Sleep, Healing Word, Faerie Fire, Dissonant Whispers. Not Thunderwave.
- The bell was ringing in Nightstone earlier but faded and stopped during the journey to cold camp.

Immediate restart block

Start exactly here:

The temporary bridge creaks faintly under its own weight. Kella is already across, crouched by the broken stone with her crossbow trained on the damaged gatehouse. Dorrin holds the tether. Xolkin stands close enough to cross next, but his eyes are on Alphie. From inside Nandar Keep, the woman calls again, "Name yourself!" The second voice follows, sharper: "How many of you?" Behind the party, the village and the temple remain silent. Alphie has the floor.